MONTHLY UPDATE

# Libya: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.*

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Legislation and regulation · Regional collaboration · Standards

FINANCE
Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Connectivity · Data Storage · Energy · Technical Capacity · Cybersecurity

DPI
Digital Identity and CRVS · Digital Payments and Fintech · Registries · Other GovTech and e-Gov

DIGITALISATION
Digitalisation of sub-national government · Rural digital data capture

CAPACITY
Training and skills

INCLUSION
Access to services

DATA
National statistics

GEOPOLITICS
US / hyperscaler activities

## Governance

### Legislation and regulation

DECISION 449 OF 2026 ON IMPORTING THROUGH BANKING CHANNELS

- **بوشيحة يصدر قرارًا لتنظيم توريد السلع والبضائع عبر القنوات المصرفية اعتبارًا من 30 سبتمبر** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 7 September 2026

  Decision 449 of 2026 routes trade-goods supply through banking channels from 30 September 2026 — not the PTS decision.

- **Tripoli Chamber of Commerce discusses decision to regulate imports for the purpose of trade** — Libya Herald, 15 September 2026

  The capital's chamber of commerce met on the economy minister's decision 449 of 2026, which from 30 September requires importers and foreign exporters to register on the unified digital trade system. Members questioned whether the date can be met and what the decision will cost them.

### Regional collaboration

ARAB STATES HIGH-LEVEL DIGITAL AND AI POLICY FORUM

- **UNDP, Ooredoo Group and Doha Institute for Graduate Studies convene Arab digital policy leaders to accelerate digital and AI policy implementation** — United Nations Development Programme, 2 September 2026

  Arab States digital policy framework moves to country roadmaps; Libya's AI minister attends.

### Standards

HIGH TECHNICAL COMMITTEE FOR THE NATIONAL INFORMATION SYSTEM

- **During its sixth regular meeting in Tripoli, the High Technical Committee for the National Information System reviewed financial indicators and established rules for membership and future work** — General Information Authority (Libya), 6 September 2026

  Permanent seats tied to the office of Director of Information and Documentation Centre; proxies need a letter.

## Finance

### Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

PUBLIC BUDGET ALLOCATION TO DIGITAL GOVERNMENT

- **بيان مصرف ليبيا المركزي عن الإيراد والإنفاق من 01/01/2026 حتى 31/08/2026** — مصرف ليبيا المركزي (Central Bank of Libya), 10 September 2026

  Libya central bank, Jan-Aug 2026: spending 68.7bn LYD, oil revenue 80.8bn, telecoms 31.1m; first under unified deal.

- **بيان الإيراد والانفاق لشهر سبتمبر – 2026** — مصرف ليبيا المركزي (Central Bank of Libya), 8 October 2026

  Central Bank of Libya's statement of state revenue and expenditure, January-September 2026, with e-payment indicators.

## ICT Infrastructure

### Connectivity

RETAIL MOBILE DATA TARIFFS

- **باقات إنترنت الهاتف المحمول** — شركة المدار الجديد (Almadar Aljadid), Libya, 3 September 2026

  A Libyan operator's live retail tariff card runs from 0.5 dinars for 50MB over one day to 80 dinars for 80GB over thirty. Libya publishes no regulated price basket, so operator cards are the only evidence of what data costs there.

SATELLITE BROADBAND OPERATOR MARKET ENTRY

- **Starlink's Libya Market Entry Remains on Hold as Negotiations Continue** — Space in Africa, 13 September 2026

  GACI sources say no agreement yet on licensing, spectrum or coverage two years into talks.

NATIONAL EMERGENCY TELECOMMUNICATIONS PLAN (NETP)

- **هيئة الاتصالات تنظم ورشة عمل حول الخطة الوطنية للاتصالات في حالات الطوارئ** — The Libya Observer (Arabic), 28 September 2026

Libya's telecoms authority and the ITU held a first two-day workshop in Tripoli to review the national emergency telecommunications plan, develop early-warning systems and a unified protocol, and set agencies' roles. The plan was conceived after communications with Derna and other eastern cities failed during Storm Daniel in 2023.

7,000 TELECOMMUNICATIONS TOWERS PROJECT

- **LPTIC Subsidiary Reviews Progress on 7,000 Telecom Towers Project** — Libya Herald, 3 October 2026

  Al-Bunya general assembly, 2 Oct 2026; towers under LPTIC 2030 vision: lower costs, new revenue, group engineers.

### Data Storage

KM-4 DATA CENTRE CERTIFICATION

- **Uptime Institute — KM-4 Data Center, Libyan International Telecom Company** — Uptime Institute, 3 September 2026

  A tier III design certification is recorded for the Libyan national telecom company's KM-4 site, the first independent assessment of a Libyan facility the repository holds. It certifies design rather than construction or operation, and no capacity figures are disclosed.

### Energy

OFF-GRID SOLAR ELECTRIFICATION OF REMOTE AREAS

- **مشروع كهربة المناطق النائية باستخدام منظومات الخلايا الشمسية** — جهاز الطاقات المتجددة (Renewable Energy Authority of Libya, REAOL), 3 September 2026

  Libya's renewable energy authority sets out its off-grid programme: 400 solar systems at 310 kW peak, serving remote population clusters and border posts. It is the largest counted state provision outside the cities the repository holds for the country.

### Technical Capacity

NATIONAL DATA-CENTRE CAPACITY

- **Uptime Institute — KM-4 Data Center, Libyan International Telecom Company** — Uptime Institute, 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

TECHNICAL AND VOCATIONAL EDUCATION MINISTRY ELECTRONIC ARCHIVING SYSTEM (UPGRADE)

- **وزارة التعليم التقني والفني تعلن قرب إطلاق النسخة المحدثة من منظومة الأرشفة الإلكترونية** — 23 وكالة الأنباء الليبية, September 2026

  Upgraded system rebuilt on user feedback with access controls and backups; operator training from 28 Sep 2026.

### Cybersecurity

INTEGRATED NATIONAL CYBERSECURITY PLAN

- **مناقشة وضع خطة وطنية متكاملة للأمن السيبراني** — 20 وكالة الأنباء الليبية (وال), September 2026

  Bin Ghalboun convenes four cyber and information bodies; emergency plans, early warning, joint monitoring.

NATIONAL OIL CORPORATION OIL-DATA LEAK INVESTIGATION

- **NOC officials in pre-trial detention for leaking sensitive oil-related data** — Libya Herald, 1 October 2026

> Libya's Attorney General's Office ordered two National Oil Corporation officials, one of them its director of information and digital transformation, into pre-trial detention over leaked oil-sector data. Data on fields, production, reserves and exploration passed to a foreign company contracted in 2023 for a sector study.

## DPI

### Digital Identity and CRVS

CIVIL-REGISTRY FRAUD ENFORCEMENT

- **إيقاف 3090 رقما وطنيا مزورا وإحالة متهمين للتحقيق** — ليبيا الأحرار, 10 September 2026

  3,090 National Numbers issued on forged civil-status data at the Majdul registry office halted.

- **ظاهرة الأرقام الوطنية المزورة تتفاقم.. كيف نسد ثغرات السجل المدني الليبي؟** — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 27 September 2026

  Libya's public prosecutor announced another case of civil-status records falsified for money, reviving concern over forged national identity numbers, which the last official tally put above 89,000. The report traces the problem to 2022, when forged numbers were found to have drawn salaries and family grants, and asks how the civil registry's gaps can be closed.

- **النائب العام يكشف تزوير 315 ألف رقم وطني وتجميد رواتب ومعاشات مرتبطة بها** — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 13 October 2026

  Over 10,000 passports on forged data; LYD 84.5m in salaries frozen; civil registry and National Number databases clash.

### Digital Payments and Fintech

GROSS VALUE OF ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OPERATIONS

- **عيسى يناقش مع المصارف التجارية توفير السيولة والنقد الأجنبي** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 3 September 2026

  LD 764.9bn of e-payments 1 January to 31 August 2026, alongside liquidity and foreign-currency measures.

- **Electronic transactions reached 865 billion Libyan dinars by end of September 2026: CBL** — Libya Herald, 5 October 2026

  Libya's central bank said electronic transactions reached about 865 billion dinars by the end of September 2026. The figure came from a meeting between the governor, commercial bank heads and the state payments company on cash liquidity, wider electronic payment and cyber-risk readiness.

ACCESSION TO CHINA'S CROSS-BORDER INTERBANK PAYMENT SYSTEM

- **CBL Governor Naji Issa Launches New Financial Initiatives** — Libya Herald, 7 September 2026

  Libya's central bank governor launched a link to the Arab regional payments platform, a study track on a central bank digital currency and stablecoins, and a cyber-skills programme, and put a pilot for accession to China's cross-border interbank system at early 2027. None of the four carries an instrument, budget, participant list or delivery date.

CENTRAL BANK PAYMENT AND DIGITAL-CURRENCY INITIATIVES

- **CBL Governor Naji Issa Launches New Financial Initiatives** — Libya Herald, 7 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

ZERO CASH CASHLESS INITIATIVE

- «منتدى تطوير القطاع المصرفي يعلن التوقف عن متابعة تنفيذ مبادرة «صفر نقد» — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 7 September 2026

  Libya's banking sector development forum said it has stopped pursuing its cashless initiative in the form submitted to the central bank, because the executive framework it needed was never issued.

DIRECT PAYMENT CORRIDOR TO CHINA

- **Libya's North Africa Bank to launch direct payment service to China using Alipay** — Libya Herald, 8 September 2026

  A privately owned Libyan bank said it will launch a direct mobile payment service to China, capped at US$5,000 a transaction and US$50,000 a year.

CENTRAL BANK CIRCULAR 9/2026 ON MOBILE PAYMENT AND ELECTRONIC WALLETS

- مصرف ليبيا المركزي يضع ضوابط جديدة للمحافظ الإلكترونية ويرفع سقف التحويل اليومي إلى مليوني دينار للشركات - Bankawy — Bankawy - 14 September 2026 أفهم .. قارن .. أختار .. سهلنا عليك المشوار,

  Circular 9/2026: e-wallets opened to legal foreign residents; daily ceilings 100k, 500k and 2m dinars.

RATIBAK LAHZI REAL-TIME PAYROLL

- **The Central Bank of Libya announces the commencement of September salary payments through the "Your Salary Instantly" system** — Central Bank of Libya, 28 September 2026

  About 1.75m of 2.2m public employees on the system, 79% participation; complaints handling being automated.

## Registries

UNIFIED ECONOMIC NUMBER

- بدء العمليات التجريبية لإصدار الرقم الاقتصادي الموحد إلكترونياً — Alwasat (Bawabat Al-Wasat), 9 September 2026

  Pilot electronic issuance under Cabinet Decision No. 348 of 2026; National Number and linked phone required to obtain it.

- **Pilot operations started for the soon-to-be-launched Unified Economic Number** — Libya Herald, 10 September 2026

  Libya's national council for the Unified Economic Number has approved the start of pilot operations for issuing the number electronically. It opens the first phase of a project to give economic, commercial and investment entities a single identity, implementing a Cabinet decision of 2026.

COMPULSORY REGISTRATION ON THE UNIFIED DIGITAL TRADE SYSTEM

- **Economy Ministry makes electronic registration mandatory for importers and exporters** — The Libya Observer, 15 September 2026

  The requirement bites in stages: a transitional period runs to the end of 2026, then from January 2027 for businesses whose annual transactions or shipments are worth US$1m or more.

- **Mandatory registration of importers and exporters in unified digital system for trade (PTS) announced by Ministry of Economy** — Libya Herald, 15 September 2026

  Decree 465 of 2026 makes registration on the unified digital trade system compulsory for importers, exporters and foreign companies supplying the market through Libyan companies, issuing a registration certificate and an electronic identification number.

### Other GovTech and e-Gov

ELECTRONIC VISA APPLICATIONS AND APPROVALS

- **مركز خدمة المواطن يبحث دعم منظومة التأشيرة الإلكترونية** — ليبيا أوبزيرفر (Libya Observer, Arabic), 5 September 2026

  Joint mechanism with the Passports Authority to take E-Visa enquiries and complaints and unify agency channels.

CUSTOMS AUTOMATED INSPECTION AND COASTAL MONITORING CONTRACTS

- **"Leading international companies" discuss with Customs Authority activating automated inspection contracts & projects** — Libya Herald, 16 September 2026

  Libya's Customs Authority met foreign contractors on 15 September 2026 to revive automated inspection, container scanning and coastal monitoring contracts signed in earlier years but never completed. The meeting reviewed what had been delivered and what had blocked the rest; no contract values or dates were given.

UNIFIED NATIONAL DATABASE FOR INTERNATIONAL SUPPORT

- **المركزي» يبحث إنشاء منظومة إلكترونية وقاعدة بيانات موحدة للدعم الدولي»** — بوابة الوسط, 21 September 2026

  Libya's central bank governor, Naji Issa, put forward an electronic system and a single national database for recording and following up international grants, projects and support. He made the proposal on 21 September 2026 at the second meeting of the committee set up under prime-ministerial decision 422 of 2026. The idea is still under discussion and has not been adopted.

ATHAR AUDIT-TASK PLATFORM

- **ديوان المحاسبة ينظم ندوة تعريفية لمنصة ( أثر) لإدارة ومتابعة المهام الرقابية .** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 8 October 2026

  Seminar for 140+ audited bodies; digital channel for audit tasks, follow-up and information exchange with the Bureau.

## Digitalisation

### Digitalisation of sub-national government

MUNICIPAL RECORDS DIGITALISATION

- **بلدية أبوسليم تبدأ تطبيق منظومة الأرشفة الإلكترونية بإدارة الموارد البشرية** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 11 September 2026

  Tripoli municipality moves staff records and HR documents from paper to an electronic archive.

### Rural digital data capture

RURAL DIGITAL SERVICE PROGRAMME

- **مشروع كهربة المناطق النائية باستخدام منظومات الخلايا الشمسية** — جهاز الطاقات المتجددة (Renewable Energy Authority of Libya, REAOL), 3 September 2026

  Summarised under Energy.

## Capacity

### Training and skills

WASL INITIATIVE FOR DIGITAL EMPOWERMENT AND ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

- **الإعلان في طرابلس عن إطلاق مبادرة (وَصْل) للتمكين الرقمي والذكاء الاصطناعي بقطاع الشؤون الاجتماعية** — Libyan News Agency (WAL), 10 October 2026

> Social Affairs and Digital Economy ministries sign MoU; AI skills for staff, digital access for people with disabilities.

## Inclusion

### Access to services

> RAQIB COMPLAINTS AND REPORTING PLATFORM

- **منصة رقيب للشكاوي والبلاغات** — 3 ,هيئة الرقابة الإدارية September 2026

  Libya's administrative oversight authority has a live complaints and reporting platform covering about 750 reportable state bodies. It launched at a Tripoli anti-corruption event in December 2025; no count of reports received or resolved is published.

> UNIVERSITY ACCESS TO A FOREIGN DIGITAL LIBRARY

- **British Council signs MoU with Benghazi University allowing access to the Council's Digital Library to 70,000 students** — Libya Herald, 9 September 2026

  MoU opens 80,000+ digital resources to over 70,000 students after the university lost much of its library in the war.

## Data

### National statistics

> ENGINEERING REPORT OF INDUSTRIAL AND ENVIRONMENTAL INDICATORS

- **Green Industry Centre report provides valuable sector data for policy and plan formulation** — Libya Herald, 10 September 2026

  Libya's industry ministry has published an engineering report of industrial and environmental indicators compiled from its own database of facilities. It records 305 registered industrial establishments, 301 of them private, and 26,034 workers, alongside data on industrial activity, resource and energy consumption and waste management.

> UNIFIED DIRECTORY FOR NATIONAL INDICATORS

- **The General Authority for Information continues its technical meetings to follow up on the work of the Unified Directory for National Indicators with sectoral information centers - GIA** — GIA - General Authority for Information, 15 September 2026

  Ministry drafts due to GIA technical team; final unified directory goes to the High Technical Committee.

## Geopolitics

### US / hyperscaler activities

> STRATEGIC COOPERATION FRAMEWORK WITH THE UNITED STATES ON TELECOMMUNICATIONS AND TECHNOLOGY

- **Libya and the US Sign Strategic Cooperation Framework** — Libyan News Agency, 8 October 2026

  Libya's communications authority and the US State Department signed a cooperation framework in Washington covering digital infrastructure, AI, data centres, cybersecurity and satellite communications. No programme or amount was published.

## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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